

Ziyu Zhou

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EDUCATION

University of Nottingham Ningbo China

Ningbo, China

BSc Hons Computer Science with Artificial Intelligence

Sept 2021 – July 2026

- Full English instruction throughout entire undergraduate study
- Awarding body: University of Nottingham, UK

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant – Machine Learning Course

[Semester]

University of Nottingham Ningbo China

- Assisted in preparing tutorial materials, grading assignments, and supporting student learning in Machine Learning coursework
- Reinforced understanding of ML algorithms, model evaluation, and data quality — directly applicable to AI training workflows

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mandarin Chinese

Native speaker, standard Northern Mandarin

Sichuan Dialect (Southwestern Mandarin)

Native speaker, spoken in Hanzhong (home region)

Shaanxi Dialect (Central Plains Mandarin)

Fluent, family language (father from Xi'an)

English

IELTS 6.0 (B2) · 4 years of full-English academic environment

RELEVANT SKILLS FOR AI TUTOR

- **Cross-dialect awareness:** Naturally distinguish between Mandarin, Southwestern Mandarin (Sichuan), and Central Plains Mandarin (Shaanxi) at phonetic, lexical, and prosodic levels
- **Phonetic observation:** Identify tonal variations, stress patterns, intonation contours, and accent features across Chinese dialects and English
- **Transcription:** Accurate character-level transcription across varying audio quality and accent conditions
- **Audio assessment:** Evaluate voice quality, recording environment, background noise, and suitability for model training
- **AI training literacy:** Understand the full pipeline – data annotation, supervised fine-tuning (SFT), RLHF, and model evaluation – from CS+AI degree
- **Technical tools:** Familiar with audio annotation platforms, Python, data processing workflows

PORTFOLIO HIGHLIGHTS

github.com/zhouziyu12/nlp-chinese

Prepared a comprehensive annotation portfolio including:

- **Voice samples:** Mandarin, Sichuan dialect, Shaanxi dialect, and English – demonstrating clear natural delivery across four language varieties
- **Annotated transcripts:** Each sample includes word-level transcription, dialect identification, prosodic analysis, and audio quality assessment

- **Dialect comparison:** Same sentence read in four varieties, with systematic comparison of tonal, lexical, and prosodic differences
- **Practice annotations:** TTS speech quality evaluation, demonstrating independent judgment on synthetic vs. human voice data

ACADEMIC & PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Computer Science with AI Degree Program

2021 – 2026

University of Nottingham Ningbo China

- Coursework in: Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Engineering
- Developed understanding of AI model training lifecycle, data quality requirements, and evaluation methodologies
- All coursework, exams, and presentations conducted in English

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Time availability:** Immediately available upon graduation (July 2026), open to full-time, part-time, or contract arrangements
- **Equipment:** Personal computer (Windows 10+), stable internet connection, smartphone
- **Location:** Ningbo, China (willing to work remotely globally)
- **No visa sponsorship required** for positions outside the US